

# Saturday, 23 May 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

## 00 — WEATHER

### Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Overcast

28° 19°

BIRMINGHAM

Light drizzle

24° 15°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

22° 15°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

18° 12°

## 01 — NEWS

### Today's top stories

1

**Starmer says he will campaign for Burnham in Makerfield.**

The prime minister says Labour needs to "all pull together and fight", after a revolt against his leadership.

POLITICS · UK

2

**Teen boys' rape sentences to be reviewed by government.**

The three teenagers were not given custodial sentences for their roles in the rape of two girls.

UK · NEWS

3

**Andrew investigation could look into sexual misconduct allegations.**

The former prince was arrested in February on suspicion of misconduct in public office.

UK · NEWS

02 – SHOWBIZ

## What's coming up

1

### **Emily in Paris to end after sixth season, says Netflix.**

Star Lily Collins announces the hit show will end with its upcoming sixth season.

SHOWBIZ · UK

2

### **Was Married at First Sight UK an 'accident waiting to happen'?**

Channel 4 has wider questions to answer after allegations made by three women who took part in the show.

SHOWBIZ · UK

3

### **'Look Mum, one point': Why does the UK keep getting Eurovision wrong?**

After four years of flops, the BBC has to think hard about how it approaches Eurovision in 2027.

SHOWBIZ · UK

## On the schedule

### 1 'It all started with Jason Statham' - Verhoeven.

Will former kickboxing world champion Rico Verhoeven "write history" against unified boxing world champion Oleksandr Usyk?

SPORT · UK

### 2 Guardiola explains decision to leave Man City.

Pep Guardiola says the club needs a new manager and new energy after he announced his decision to leave Manchester City at the end of the season.

SPORT · UK

### 3 What's your favourite Football Focus moment?.

The longest-running football magazine show in the world comes to an end this Sunday after 52 years and here are some of our favourite moments.

SPORT · UK

### 4 The games that defined Guardiola's Premier League titles.

BBC Sport looks back at the defining moments of Pep Guardiola's six Premier League titles, as he prepares to leave Manchester City after 10 trophy-laden years.

SPORT · UK

## Quick hits

- 1 Three quarters of dog owners now talk to their dog more than they talk to their partner.**  
Top topics: 'what we're doing later', 'what we just saw out the window' and a surprising amount of Bake Off commentary. 12% admit they've apologised to the dog after a row with the human.
- 2 Almost two thirds of us say we've cried at a podcast in the last year — grief, parenting and identity top the list of triggers.**  
Researchers reckon it's the intimacy of audio that does it. The figure is even higher for under-30s, 71% of whom admit a recent podcast-induced tear.
- 3 The average Brit checks their phone 159 times a day — but says it 'doesn't feel like that much'.**  
Researchers using passive monitoring apps say we badly underestimate our own usage. Most people guess between 30 and 70 times.
- 4 One in three of us has had a 'sleep divorce' — sleeping in a separate bed from our partner.**  
Reasons: snoring (45%), different schedules (30%), restless legs, and one bizarre 12% who say their partner 'talks to the cat in their sleep'.
- 5 Brits spend an average of 38 minutes a day deciding what to watch — and 12 of those are spent scrolling Netflix.**  
'Watch-paralysis' has its own subreddit. Streamers are quietly experimenting with 'shuffle' buttons that just play something.
- 6 The fastest-growing hobby of 2026 is hand-embroidery — sales of needles and thread up 180% in a year.**  
Crafters say it's the perfect 'phone detox' — slow, tactile, satisfying. TikTok is full of 20-somethings showing off custom denim jackets.
- 7 Half of UK adults can't name a single member of the cabinet — but 80% can name three Love Island contestants.**  
Political engagement researchers say it's not apathy so much as 'noise overload'. People remember faces from things they actively watch.

05 – TALKBACK

## For the phone lines

### OUR SURVEY SAID

- Q** 69% of Brits do THIS as soon as they get in from work. What?

**ANSWER:** TAKE THEIR TROUSERS OFF AND PUT PYJAMA BOTTOMS ON.
- Q** 39% of us have done THIS in a supermarket trolley aisle. What?

**ANSWER:** HAD A FULL DOMESTIC ARGUMENT.

### TALK TOPIC

- **A survey says 30% of us have a 'forever favourite' meal we'd be happy eating every day.**  
Talk-back: what's yours? And could you really eat it every day?
- **Researchers say the average person has 27 unread voicemails. We're voicemail-phobic.**  
Talk-back: when did you last actually listen to one? And who left it?

### TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

- FACT** **UK News.** A council in the North-West has agreed to fix a much-complained-about pothole only after a resident planted a small tree in it and the photo went viral. The pothole had been reported 17 times in a year before the tree solved it overnight.
- FICTION** **Made up, but believable.** A Devon village has voted unanimously to ban Vinted couriers from parking on its narrow high street, after a single delivery driver knocked over the same pub's hanging basket three weeks in a row.

06 – LOTTERY

## Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

**£10.75 million**

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

**£10.75 million**

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

## Did you know?

- The plastic bits on the ends of shoelaces are called aglets.
- Penguins propose to their mates by giving them a pebble.
- Strawberries aren't actually berries, but bananas, watermelons and pumpkins are.
- Cats have a special collarbone that lets them always land on their feet — usually.
- The word 'set' has the most definitions of any word in the English language — 430.
- The longest English word without a vowel is 'rhythms'.
- Ketchup was sold in the 1830s as medicine.
- Hippos secrete their own natural sunscreen — a reddish, oily substance.

## On this day

Day 143 of the year, 222 days left in 2026. Today Aromanian National Day; Christian feast day: Aaron the Illustrious (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Desiderius of Vienne; Christian feast day: Giovanni Battista de' Rossi. Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

### TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1933 — Joan Collins, English actress
- 1977 — Richard Ayoade, British actor, director and writer
- 1980 — Chris Gethard, American actor, comedian and writer
- 1986 — Ryan Coogler, American film director and screenwriter
- 1967 — Philip Selway, English musician
- 1954 — Gerry Armstrong, Northern Irish international footballer
- 1966 — H. Jon Benjamin, American actor, comedian, writer, and producer
- 1941 — Zalman King, American director, producer, and screenwriter (died 2012)

### THE DAY TODAY

- 1978 — A Tupolev Tu-144 crashes near the Russian town of Yegoryevsk, killing two.
- 2013 — A freeway bridge carrying Interstate 5 over the Skagit River collapses in Mount Vernon, Washington.
- 1971 — Seventy-eight people are killed when Aviogenex Flight 130 crashes on approach to Rijeka Airport in present-day Rijeka, Croatia (then the Socialist Federal Republic of Yugoslavia).

### TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2013 — A freeway bridge carrying Interstate 5 over the Skagit River collapses in Mount Vernon, Washington.
- 1992 — Italy's most prominent anti-mafia judge Giovanni Falcone, his wife and three body guards are killed by the Corleonesi clan with a half-ton bomb near Capaci, Sicily. His friend and colleague Paolo Borsellino will be assassinated less than two months later, making 1992 a turning...

### TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1980 — The Shining, the psychological horror film directed by Stanley Kubrick, is premiered on 10 screens in New York City and Los Angeles on the Memorial Day weekend.

- 1949 — Cold War: The Western occupying powers approve the Basic Law and establish a new German state, the Federal Republic of Germany.
- 1945 — World War II: Heinrich Himmler, head of the Schutzstaffel, commits suicide while in Allied custody.

## A peek at tomorrow

Day 144 of the year, 221 days left in 2026. Today Aldersgate Day/Wesley Day (Methodism); Battle of Pichincha Day (Ecuador); Bermuda Day (Bermuda), celebrated on the nearest weekday if May 24 falls on the weekend.; Christian feast day: Anna Pak Agi (one of The Korean Martyrs). Star sign Gemini, birthstone Emerald.

### TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1989 — G-Eazy, American rapper
- 1949 — Jim Broadbent, English actor
- 1967 — Heavy D, Jamaican-American rapper, producer, and actor (died 2011)
- 1947 — Waddy Wachtel, American guitarist, singer-songwriter, and record producer
- 1965 — John C. Reilly, American actor
- 1988 — Billy Gilman, American musician
- 1937 — Archie Shepp, American saxophonist and composer
- 1986 — Mark Ballas, American singer-songwriter, guitarist, dancer, and actor

### THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1999 — The International Criminal Tribunal for the former Yugoslavia in The Hague, Netherlands indicts Slobodan Milošević and four others for war crimes and crimes against humanity committed in Kosovo.
- 1981 — Ecuadorian president Jaime Roldós Aguilera, his wife, and his presidential committee die in an aircraft accident while travelling from Quito to Zapotillo minutes after the president gave a famous speech regarding the 24 de mayo anniversary of the Battle of Pichincha.
- 2014 — A 6.4 magnitude earthquake occurs in the Aegean Sea between Greece and Turkey, injuring 324 people.

### TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1956 — The first Eurovision Song Contest is held in Lugano, Switzerland.
- 2014 — At least three people are killed in a shooting at Brussels' Jewish Museum of Belgium.

# Coming to cinemas

|           |                                                       |
|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| MAY 2026  |                                                       |
| FRI 15    | Mortal Kombat II (+ IMAX); Is God Is; Poetic License  |
| FRI 22    | The Mandalorian and Grogu (+ IMAX)                    |
| JUNE 2026 |                                                       |
| FRI 5     | Masters of the Universe; Power Ballad                 |
| FRI 12    | Scary Movie 6; new Spielberg film (+ IMAX)            |
| FRI 19    | Pixar's Toy Story 5                                   |
| FRI 26    | Supergirl: Woman of Tomorrow (+ IMAX); A Private Life |
| JULY 2026 |                                                       |
| WED 1     | Minions & Monsters                                    |
| FRI 3     | Shiver; Young Washington                              |
| FRI 10    | Moana (live action); Evil Dead Burn                   |
| FRI 17    | Christopher Nolan's The Odyssey (+ IMAX); Cut Off     |
| FRI 24    | Heads of State; Untitled DCU                          |
| FRI 31    | Spider-Man: Brand New Day                             |

|                          |                                                 |
|--------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|
| AUGUST 2026              |                                                 |
| FRI 7                    | Once Upon a Time in a Cinema                    |
| FRI 14                   | Flowervale Street; PAW Patrol 3: The Dino Movie |
| FRI 21                   | Mutiny; The Bride!                              |
| FRI 28                   | Crime 101; Outcome                              |
| SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW |                                                 |
| FRI 4                    | Conjuring: Last Rites                           |
| FRI 11                   | Resident Evil reboot                            |
| FRI 18                   | The Black Phone 2                               |
| FRI 25                   | Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)                             |
| OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW   |                                                 |
| FRI 16                   | Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller         |
| FRI 23                   | Frankenstein (del Toro)                         |

On the sporting calendar

|                 |                                                  |                |                                        |
|-----------------|--------------------------------------------------|----------------|----------------------------------------|
| MAY 2026        |                                                  | JULY 2026      |                                        |
| THU 14          | PGA Championship begins (Golf)                   | 4–26 JUL       | Tour de France (Cycling)               |
| WED 20          | UEFA Europa League Final                         | SUN 5          | British Grand Prix, Silverstone        |
| SAT 23          | EFL Championship Play-off Final, Wembley         | 16–19 JUL      | The Open Championship (Golf)           |
| SUN 24          | Premier League final day (all 10 games, 3pm BST) | 18–26 JUL      | World Matchplay Darts, Blackpool       |
| 24 MAY – 7 JUN  | French Open (Tennis)                             | 23 JUL – 2 AUG | Commonwealth Games, Glasgow            |
| THU 28          | Premier League Darts Finals Night                | AUGUST 2026    |                                        |
| SAT 30          | UEFA Champions League Final                      | W/C 10         | Hundred & T20 Blast climax (Cricket)   |
| JUNE 2026       |                                                  | SAT 15         | Premier League season begins (2026/27) |
| THU 4           | NBA Finals begin                                 | 22–23          | Belgian Grand Prix (F1)                |
| 11 JUN – 19 JUL | FIFA World Cup (USA / Canada / Mexico)           |                |                                        |
| 11–14 JUN       | World Cup of Darts                               |                |                                        |
| 12 JUN – 5 JUL  | ICC Women's T20 World Cup (England & Wales)      |                |                                        |
| 18–21 JUN       | U.S. Open (Golf)                                 |                |                                        |
| 29 JUN – 12 JUL | Wimbledon                                        |                |                                        |